ELAH center
For coping with loss

War with Iran

Proposal for a Program of Support and Supervision for Social Workers in Municipal Social Service Departments

The Elah Center specializes for many years in treatment of trauma, bereavement and loss. The Center's operates nationwide and includes approximately 600 experienced professionals from the fields of therapy and emotional support, all working out of a deep commitment to strengthening social resilience and mental health in Israel.

Strengthening resilience for those directly affected by traumatic events. Due to the war, we would like to offer, a complementary nationwide newly badly needed response.

strengthening and supporting social workers in municipal social service departments in Israel's cities, regional councils, and local authorities. These professionals face heavy workloads while serving diverse populations. They are exposed to extreme cases and are required to find creative solutions in the absence of sufficient budgets and within an exceptionally challenging social, economic, and security reality. This becomes even more pronounced during periods of war. Since October 2023, the State of Israel has been engaged in prolonged warfare, creating an unprecedented emotional and social burden on its citizens. Now, in light of the escalation and the current war with Iran, increasing numbers of civilians are being affected, and the pressures on social workers continue to intensify. This ongoing exposure places these professionals at significant risk of experiencing vicarious trauma, secondary traumatization, and compassion fatigue.

The support we propose to offer within this program includes:

- Ongoing group supervision sessions
- Individual supervision and personal support for staff
- Short-term workshops for staff (a focused series of meetings combining experiential elements, knowledge sharing, and practical tools)
- Educational lectures (on topics such as bereavement, trauma, self-care, and related subjects)

Elah Center seeks to collaborate with local authorities and governmental bodies to establish a dedicated and comprehensive support within the described framework. Strengthening the professionals on the social front line is essential for maintaining the resilience of Israeli society during this complex period and for ensuring the continuity of services for citizens who need them more than ever.

As the CEO of the Elah Center, I am reaching out to you personally to request your generous support, which will enable us to continue working to strengthen social resilience by supporting the social workers who carry a heavy responsibility for the wellbeing of Israeli society during this challenging time.
Sincerely,
Bennie Leezer, CEO

Contact:
Bennie Leezer, CEO
052-3589919
CEO@elah.org.il
www.elah.org.il
Social Media (in Hebrew): Facebook | Instagram | Linkedin